ALI GOKHAN KARABILGIN

Applied Economist

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Profile

Applied economist researching labour-market policy, education and firm productivity. Experience working with company accounts and survey microdata, designing empirical studies, and communicating findings through papers, presentations and teaching.

Experience

PhD Researcher in Economics

University of Glasgow, Glasgow, UK — Sep 2022 – present

- Designed and conducted three doctoral studies using exposure-based difference-in-differences, event-study analysis and partial identification to examine UK investment and productivity.
- Built and linked datasets using UK company accounts, government records of employers authorised to sponsor migrant workers, labour force surveys, and sectoral investment and productivity data.
- Developed reproducible Stata code; prepared research papers and conference presentations.

Tutor

University of Glasgow, Glasgow, UK — Sep 2023 – present

- Teach undergraduate economics and econometrics through tutorials and computer labs, explaining model assumptions, analytical methods and economic interpretation.
- Develop teaching materials that build intuition; assess quantitative and written work and provide structured feedback.

Research Assistant

Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey — Jan 2018 – Sep 2022

- Developed research projects, prepared datasets and documented Stata code; conducted econometric analysis and robustness checks, and produced tables, figures and summaries.
- Coordinated student assistants on data and coding tasks; delivered econometrics tutorials and software workshops.

Education

PhD in Economics

University of Glasgow, Glasgow, UK — Sep 2022 – present

Thesis submitted September 2026; viva scheduled November 2026; award pending.
Thesis: Three Essays on Productivity and Investment in the UK.

Doctoral Studies in Economics

Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey — 2020 – 2022

Coursework completed before continuing at Glasgow; no degree awarded.

MSc in Economics

Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey — Oct 2020

BSc in Economics

Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey — Jun 2017

Research papers

Employer-Sponsored Migration as a Firm Capability: Evidence on Firm Productivity

With Dimitris Christelis | Work in progress

Uses partial identification to bound causal effects of holding a licence to sponsor migrant workers under the UK's pre-2020 rules. Under the identifying assumptions, finds positive effects on sponsors' labour and total factor productivity.

Investment and Firm Productivity: Partial Identification Evidence from UK Firms

With Dimitris Christelis and John Tsoukalas | Work in progress

Uses partial identification to bound causal effects of tangible-investment intensity. Under the identifying assumptions, medium and high investment raise UK firms' labour and total factor productivity relative to low investment.

Minimum-Wage Exposure and Investment Composition: Evidence from UK Sectors

Sole-authored | Work in progress

Uses exposure-based difference-in-differences with sector-specific trends and distributed lags. Finds suggestive evidence of higher machinery investment in more-exposed UK sectors, but no robust evidence of broader investment or employment responses.

Schooling and Labor Market Effects of the Extension of Non-Compulsory High School Education: Quasi-experimental Evidence from Turkey

With Meltem Dayıoğlu and Sezgin Polat | Working paper

Uses birth-cohort regression discontinuity to evaluate Turkey's extension of non-compulsory high school. Finds higher teenage enrolment and better wages and job quality among female wage earners, but lower high-school completion and slightly lower employment among young men.

Technical skills and languages

Econometrics	Difference-in-differences and event studies; regression discontinuity; partial identification; panel-data and distributed-lag models.
Data analysis	Microdata cleaning and linkage; productivity and investment measurement; robustness and sensitivity analysis.
Stata	Advanced: data management and econometric programming.
Python and R	Working knowledge.
Other tools	Microsoft Excel and LaTeX (advanced); Tableau.
Languages	English (fluent); Turkish (native).

Conference presentations

38th Annual Conference of the European Association of Labour Economists
EALE, University of Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain — Aug – Sep 2026

XXXIV Meeting of the Economics of Education Association
AEDE, University of La Rioja, Logroño, Spain — Jul 2026

Award

Productivity Institute PhD Scholarship — 2022